which will result in many more victims on both sides, particularly civilians. Apart from the moral and legal implications, entering the Gaza Strip may be a mistake. But getting rid of Hamas without entering the area may be impossible. And of course there are the Israeli hostages in the hands of Hamas. What a terrible mess!

Official sources are still unable to provide much information to many families about their missing relatives, another scandal, to put it mildly. Unofficial sources report about 400 Israelis unaccounted for.

At present, it remains unclear whether Iran was behind Hamas's attack, or if it had any prior knowledge of operational details of the strike. But apart from such precise involvement, it remains clear that for years Tehran has financed Hamas, supported its general aims, offered it all the weapons it needed, and supported its ideological and strategic aims, particularly the destruction of Israel and the liberation of Palestine by force. Thus, regardless of how one wishes to interpret such facts, its direct complicity is a moot question.

News stories detailing what happened in this or that spot in the South are very hard to bear because the few survivors all tell a similar story of resistance by the inhabitants, who fought the Hamas militants until their homes were reduced to rubble—but not before the children, the women, and the elderly were either slaughtered or transported back to Gaza as hostages. And all this time, the army was nowhere to be seen.

Thursday, October 12

Nothing new on the ground for the time being. A waiting period that may last. *Time* magazine published an article on Netanyahu's responsibility for part of the country's present tragedy. If one stresses the word "part," I agree. Of course the main responsibility for what is going on falls on Hamas. That is clear, but Netanyahu and his coalition's absolute dismissal of the